Past simple of to be

Nombre: _____ Fecha: _____

Qué vas a aprender

- Conjugar el pasado de to be: was y were
- Formar negativas, preguntas y respuestas cortas en pasado
- Usar there was y there were
- Usar expresiones de tiempo pasado como yesterday, last y ago

Para pensar

En español, el pasado de «ser» y «estar» tiene muchas formas: era, fue, estaba, estuvo, fui, estuve... ¿Cuántas formas tiene el pasado de to be en inglés?

Explicación

Was y were

El pasado de *to be* tiene dos formas. **Was** se usa con **I, he, she, it**: «I **was** at home», «She **was** my teacher», «It **was** cold». **Were** se usa con **you, we, they**: «You **were** late», «We **were** in Rome», «They **were** happy».

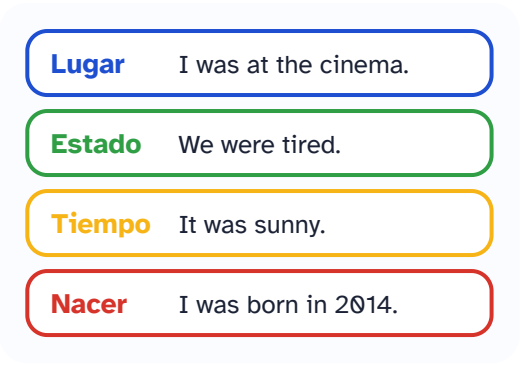
Un truco para recordarlo: las personas que en presente usan *am* o *is* pasan a **was**; las que usan *are* pasan a **were**. No hay formas contraídas en afirmativa: siempre se escribe completo.

Presente	Pasado
I am	I was
he/she/it is	was
you/we/they are	were

Usos del pasado de to be

Usamos *was / were* para hablar de **estados y situaciones del pasado**: dónde estaba alguien («I **was** at the cinema yesterday»), cómo era o cómo se sentía («He **was** very shy when he was a child», «We **were** tired after the trip»), qué tiempo hacía («It **was** sunny») o cómo fue algo («The concert **was** amazing»).

También para decir dónde y cuándo **nacimos**, porque en inglés «nacer» se dice **be born**: «I **was born** in 2014», «My parents **were born** in Ecuador». Y, como en presente, para expresiones con «tener»: «I **was** hungry» (tenía hambre), «She **was** twelve» (tenía doce años).



La negativa

Para negar se añade not: was not → **wasn't**, were not → **weren't**. En la conversación casi siempre se usan las formas contraídas: «I **wasn't** at school yesterday», «The questions **weren't** difficult», «It **wasn't** my fault».

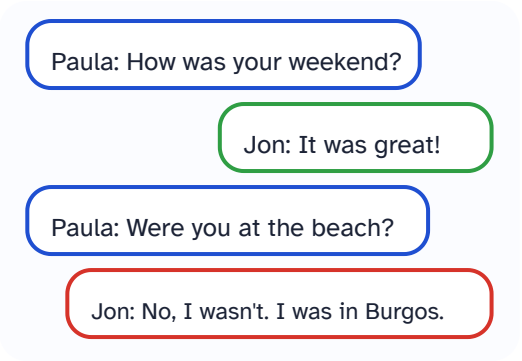
Como en presente, con *be* no se usan auxiliares: «I didn't was» es incorrecto. La negación va directamente con was o were. Para dar más fuerza se puede decir «It wasn't **very** good» o «They weren't **at all** happy» (no estaban nada contentos).



Preguntas y respuestas cortas

Para preguntar se coloca was / were delante del sujeto: «**Were** you at the party?», «**Was** it expensive?», «**Was** your brother at home?».

Las respuestas cortas son: «Yes, I **was**» / «No, I **wasn't**»; «Yes, they **were**» / «No, they **weren't**». Con palabras interrogativas: «**Where were** you last night?», «**How was** your weekend?» (¿qué tal tu fin de semana?), «**What was** the weather like?» (¿qué tiempo hizo?), «**When were** you born?».



There was y there were

El pasado de *there is / there are* es there was (singular) y there were (plural); equivalen a «había» o «hubo». «**There was** a big tree in the square», «**There were** lots of people at the concert».

La negativa es **there wasn't** y **there weren't**, con *any* en plural: «There weren't any tickets». Las preguntas: «**Was there** a problem?», «**Were there** any animals?», con respuestas cortas: «Yes, there was», «No, there weren't». Para preguntar la cantidad: «How many people **were there**?».

Presente	Pasado
there is	there was
there are	there were
is there...?	was there...?

Expresiones de tiempo pasado

Para situar algo en el pasado usamos estas expresiones: **yesterday** (ayer), **yesterday morning / afternoon**, **the day before yesterday** (anteayer) y **last** + night / week / month / year / summer / Monday (anoche, la semana pasada...). Ojo: se dice *last night*, no «yesterday night».

Con **ago** indicamos cuánto tiempo hace, y va **detrás** de la cantidad: «two days **ago**» (hace dos días), «five years **ago**», «a long time **ago**». También: **in** + año («in 2020») y **when I was** + edad («when I was six»).

Inglés	Español
yesterday	ayer
last night	anoche
last week / year	la semana pasada / el año pasado
three days ago	hace tres días
in 2019	en 2019
when I was six	cuando tenía seis años

undefined

Was o were: comparar con el presente

Comparar el presente y el pasado ayuda a ver qué ha cambiado: «Now I **'m** twelve, but five years ago I **was** seven». «Today it **'s** sunny, but yesterday it **was** rainy». «My grandparents **are** retired now, but they **were** farmers».

Este contraste es muy útil para hablar de cómo eras de pequeño o de cómo era tu ciudad antes: «When I was little, I **was** very shy. My favourite toy **was** a red car. There **wasn't** a park near my house, but there **were** lots of children in my street».



Un texto en pasado

Lee este texto sobre una excursión: «Last Friday our class **was** on a school trip to a science museum. The bus journey **was** long, but it **wasn't** boring because my friends **were** with me. The museum **was** enormous. There **were** robots, planets and a big dinosaur skeleton. There **was** also a room with experiments. My favourite part **was** the planetarium. We **were** very tired at the end, but it **was** a fantastic day!»

Busca todas las formas de was y were y fíjate en el sujeto de cada una: con *the journey* o *the museum* (it) va was; con *my friends* o *we*, were.

Last Friday we were at a museum.

The museum was enormous.

There were robots and planets.

It was a fantastic day!

Was y were

I / he / she / it	you / we / they	había	cuándo
WAS	**WERE**	**THERE WAS**	**AGO**
I was tired	we were late	there were	yesterday
it wasn't cold	they weren't	Was there...?	last night

Ejercicios

1. **Completa: She ___ at the library. You ___ late.**

2. **Pasa a pasado: «It is cold» y «We are at home».**

3. **Pon en negativa: «The exam was easy».**

4. **Haz la pregunta: «Your friends were at the party».**

5. **Responde con una respuesta corta afirmativa: «Was it fun?».**

6. **Traduce: «¿Dónde estabas anoche?».**

7. **Completa con there was o there were: ___ a lot of snow. ___ many cars.**

8. **¿Cómo se dice «nací en Bilbao»?**

9. **Ordena: ago / weeks / three / was / it.**

10. **Escribe tres frases sobre cómo eras a los seis años.**

Practica

1. **«I ___ at home yesterday.»**
   - **A)** were
   - **B)** was
   - **C)** am
2. **«They ___ very happy.»**
   - **A)** was
   - **B)** is
   - **C)** were
3. **La negativa de «was» es...**
   - **A)** wasn't
   - **B)** didn't was
   - **C)** weren't
4. **«___ you at school yesterday?»**
   - **A)** Was
   - **B)** Did
   - **C)** Were
5. **«Was it expensive?» — «No, ___.»**
   - **A)** it didn't
   - **B)** it wasn't
   - **C)** it weren't
6. **«___ a lot of people at the concert.»**
   - **A)** There were
   - **B)** There was
   - **C)** It were
7. **«Anoche» es...**
   - **A)** yesterday night
   - **B)** last night
   - **C)** ago night
8. **«Hace dos días» es...**
   - **A)** ago two days

B) before two days

C) two days ago

9. **«Nací en 2013» es...**

A) I was born in 2013.

B) I born in 2013.

C) I am born in 2013.

10. **«How ___ your holiday?»**

A) were

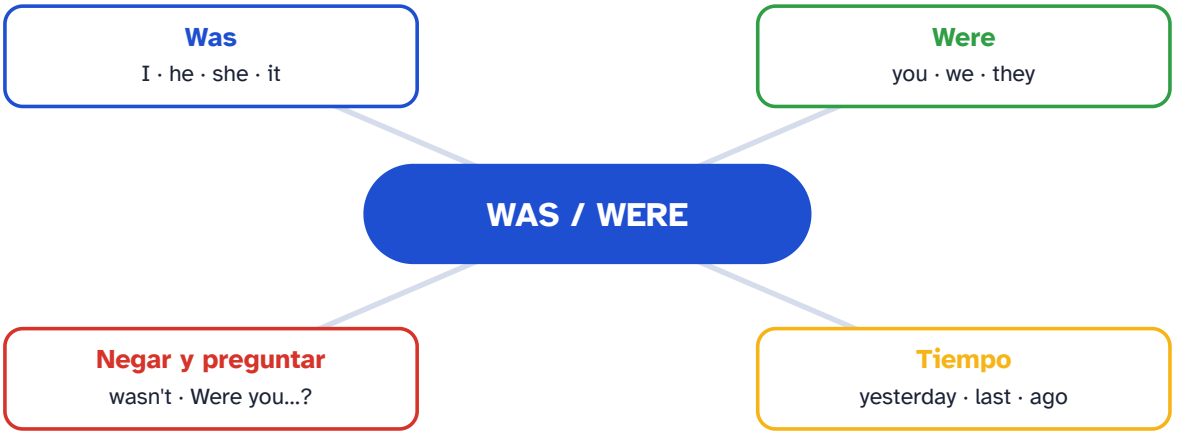
B) was

C) did

Explícalo con tus palabras

Incluye: Cuándo se usa was y cuándo were; Cómo se niega y se pregunta en pasado con be; Cómo se dice «había» en inglés; Qué expresiones de tiempo pasado conozco.

Resumen



Tarjetas de repaso

Recórtalas: pregunta delante, respuesta detrás.

was

Pasado de be con I, he, she, it.

were

Pasado de be con you, we, they.

wasn't / weren't

Negativas.

Were you…? — Yes, I was.

Pregunta y respuesta corta.

there was / there were

Había (singular / plural).

I was born in…

Nací en…

last night / last week

Anoche / la semana pasada.

two days ago

Hace dos días.

Soluciones

1. **B)** I → was.
2. **C)** They → were.
3. **A)** Was + not.
4. **C)** You → were.
5. **B)** Respuesta corta.
6. **A)** Plural.
7. **B)** Last night.
8. **C)** Ago detrás.
9. **A)** Be born.
10. **B)** Your holiday = it.

Soluciones de los ejercicios

1. was; were.
2. It was cold. We were at home.
3. The exam wasn't easy.
4. Were your friends at the party?
5. Yes, it was.
6. Where were you last night?
7. There was; There were.
8. I was born in Bilbao.
9. It was three weeks ago.
10. Respuesta modelo: When I was six, I was very small. My favourite colour was green. My best friend was Lucía.